

Thomas Ratliff

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Summary

5+ years building and shipping XR experiences in Unity. Experience in rapid prototyping across VR, MR, and mobile, as well as performance optimization, 3D design, real-time shaders, and VFX.

Experience

Scripting Technical Artist | Meta (Contract via Insight Global) | Burlingame, CA | April 2025 - Present

- Building prototypes for AI-native game creation tools that generate assets and gameplay logic from natural-language prompts, proving out generative AI workflows for game development
- Collaborated with artists and designers to implement 3D assets, VFX, and runtime logic for Horizon Central, the central hub for Horizon Worlds, shown at Meta Connect 2025
- Worked with team of Technical Artists to implement CDN based optimizations to reduce loading time between 50-player Horizon Central worlds on Quest hardware to below 10 seconds while maintaining visual fidelity

Technical Artist | HTC Creative Labs | Remote | January 2023 – April 2025

- Delivered metaverse research prototypes concept-to-demo with research, design, and engineering teams
- Built demos validating newly released Vive developer APIs and MR capabilities on Vive Focus Vision hardware
- Drove lighting, shaders, VFX, and performance for home environments shipped in the Vive Focus Vision OS

Technical Artist | Remio VR | Remote | March 2021 – December 2022

- Shipped VR collaboration tools and team-building games using Unity adopted by public and enterprise customers
- Hit Quest standalone performance targets by optimizing meshes, materials, shaders, textures, cutting draw calls
- Produced 3D characters, environments and in-game objects, shaders, particle effects, and animations

Technical Artist | MAGIC Spell Studios | Rochester, NY | May 2020 – December 2020

- Worked with a small agile team to develop prototypes in Unity for a MAGIC Spell Studios original game
- Designed and developed VFX (shaders and particle systems) as well as player UI systems

Skills

Languages: C#, TypeScript, HLSL, C++, JavaScript, Java

XR: Unity URP, Unity Profiler, Perfetto, Shader Graph, Meta XR SDK, OpenXR, XR Interaction Toolkit, FMOD, Unreal Engine

Art: Blender, Maya, ZBrush, Substance Painter (PBR Workflows), Photoshop

Tools: Git, GitHub, Visual Studio, AI Assisted pipelines (Claude Code, Codex, Unity CLI, Meshy AI)

Projects

VRTistry | Personal Project | vrtistry.app | August 2025 - Present

- Creating a VR party game where players join from phones as controllers via WebGL, networked with Normcore
- Integrated vision-based AI to interpret player-created artwork and generate fun, context-aware guess choices

Soundchek | Live Music Social App (4-person team) | soundchek.app | May 2026 - Present

- Shipped a React Native/TypeScript social app to the App Store; own auth, messaging, and notifications
- Integrated LLMs for natural-language search and event enrichment; agent-driven CI reviews and tests every PR

Meta Ray-Ban Display Prototypes | Personal Project | dev-tom.com/mrbd | July 2026

- Built three on-device prototypes in a week: vision-model pool coach, watch-sensor rep counter, gesture game
- Benchmarked vision models for latency/accuracy; designed glanceable hands-free UI for wearable constraints

Luminar | Personal Project | tinyurl.com/luminarwebbrowser | November 2023 - Present

- Developing mixed reality web browsing app with real-time lighting visual effects, published on Meta Horizon Store

Quest Camera Kit | Open Source Contribution | github.com/xrdevrob/QuestCameraKit | March 2025

- Contributed passthrough shader samples to a 569-star reference project for Quest's Passthrough Camera API

Education

Rochester Institute of Technology (RIT), Rochester, NY | August 2017 – December 2020

B.S. Game Design & Development, magna cum laude; Minors: 3D Digital Design, Psychology